SHEET 1 OF 6 · FOLDER LABELS

Folder labels that do the remembering

Three folders hold almost everything a tax season asks of you: one for money that arrived, one for money that went out, and one for the paperwork that turns expense into deduction. Print this page, cut along the dashed lines, tape a label on each folder.

TAX YEAR 20____ — FOLDER 1

INCOME

Everything that proves money came in: W-2s, whatever 1099s address you personally, last pay stubs, invoices marked PAID, interest statements, refund or benefit letters. If any evidence of money arriving lands on paper, it lands here first.

TAX YEAR 20____ — FOLDER 2

EXPENSES

Everything that shows money went out: receipts, bills, monthly statements, invoices you paid, supply orders, repair tickets. Nothing gets judged here. Folder 2 is a net, not a decision.

TAX YEAR 20____ — FOLDER 3

DEDUCTIONS

The shortlist pieces you already suspect will matter: charity receipts, medical expense statements, mileage pages from Sheet 3, home-office and education paperwork. Sorted out of Folder 2 whenever you have ten spare minutes.

Small labels for sub-folders, boxes, or envelopes

W-2 JOBS

One packet per employer. Copy the boxes when it arrives, then let the folder hold the original.

1099 FREELANCE

NEC, MISC, K: one per client or platform. A platform paper for every storefront, if you sell things.

BANK & INTEREST

December statements, interest summaries, anything a bank mails about money earned.

MEDICAL

Statements, pharmacy printouts, insurance letters. They arrive all year; they tax once.

HOME

Mortgage and property tax statements, improvement receipts, utility oddities.

VEHICLE & MILEAGE

This kit's mileage log pages, maintenance notes, parking stubs. Same-dated pages only.

CHARITY

Donation receipts and thank-you letters, one envelope per organization keeps them honest.

RECEIPTS TO SORT

The pocket where loose receipts wait to be triaged into the folders above. Empty it monthly.

WAITING ON OTHERS

For forms other people owe you. Write names on the label edge; keep a small list inside of what is owed and since when.

WARM TIP

Tape labels onto what you already own — manila folders, cereal boxes, envelopes in a shoebox. The system that exists beats the system that is perfect. Big labels go on the front; small ones label tab tops or envelope lips. If a label's category turns out not to apply to you, that is the system working, not failing.

This is a paper organizer, never tax, legal, or financial advice.